You could use this approach to automate recurring tasks, like checking the status of a system, cleaning up unused resources like EBS snapshots, or to send recurring reports.

So far, you have used a predefined template. Lambda gets much more powerful when you write your own code. But before we look into that, you will learn how to monitor your Lambda function and get notified via email whenever the health check fails.

6.2.2 Use CloudWatch to search through your Lambda function's logs

How do you know whether your website health check is working correctly? How do you even know whether your Lambda function has been executed? It is time to look at how to monitor a Lambda function. You will learn how to access your Lambda function's log messages first. Afterward, you will create an alarm notifying you if your function fails.

Open the Monitor tab in the details view of your Lambda function. You will find a chart illustrating the number of times your function has been invoked. Reload the chart after a few minutes, in case the chart isn't showing any invocations. To go to your Lambda function's logs, click View Logs in CloudWatch, as shown in figure 6.8.